

List all shell aliases in a colored, formatted display

Author: marcos

Date: 2026-04-25

Lists all aliases defined in the user's bash shell configuration file in alphabetical order with colored, formatted output. Works with bash, zsh, and other shells on Linux and BSD systems.

Language

bash

Category

shell-utilities

Command

```
bash -c 'shell_conf="${1:-$HOME/.bashrc}"; [ -f "$shell_conf" ] || { echo "Configuration file not found: $shell_conf"; exit 1; }; grep -E "^[[:space:]]*alias[[:space:]]" "$shell_conf" | sed -E "s/^[[:space:]]*alias[[:space:]]*//" | sort -f | while IFS= read -r line; do alias_name=${line%*=*}; alias_cmd=${line#*=*}; printf "\033[1;34m%-20s\033[0m -> \033[1;32m%s\033[0m\n" "$alias_name" "$alias_cmd"; done'
```

Explanation

This command reads the user's shell configuration file from the path passed as the first argument (defaulting to `~/.bashrc`), extracts alias definitions, sorts them alphabetically by alias name, and prints the alias name in blue and the stored alias command in green. It preserves the command text as written after the equals sign, which keeps the direct shell syntax intact and avoids fragile quote-stripping logic.

Tags

shell, alias, utilities, configuration, listing

Dependencies

bash, grep, sed, sort

Arguments

1. **CONFIG_FILE** (Optional): Path to shell configuration file (optional, defaults to ~/.bashrc)
Default: ~/.bashrc

Examples

1.

```
bash -c 'shell_conf="${1:-$HOME/.bashrc}"; [ -f "$shell_conf" ] || { echo "Configuration file not found: $shell_conf"; exit 1; }; grep -E "^[[:space:]]*alias[[:space:]]" "$shell_conf" | sed -E "s/^[[:space:]]*alias[[:space:]]*/" | sort -f | while IFS= read -r line; do alias_name=${line%*=*}; alias_cmd=${line#*=*}; printf "\{\}\{033[1;34m%-20s\}\{033[0m -> \{\}\{033[1;32m%s\}\{033[0m\}\{033[0m\}\{033[0m\n" "$alias_name" "$alias_cmd"; done' - - List all aliases from the default shell configuration file in alphabetical order
```
2.

```
bash -c 'shell_conf="${1:-$HOME/.bashrc}"; [ -f "$shell_conf" ] || { echo "Configuration file not found: $shell_conf"; exit 1; }; grep -E "^[[:space:]]*alias[[:space:]]" "$shell_conf" | sed -E "s/^[[:space:]]*alias[[:space:]]*/" | sort -f | while IFS= read -r line; do alias_name=${line%*=*}; alias_cmd=${line#*=*}; printf "\{\}\{033[1;34m%-20s\}\{033[0m -> \{\}\{033[1;32m%s\}\{033[0m\}\{033[0m\}\{033[0m\n" "$alias_name" "$alias_cmd"; done' - ~/.zshrc - List all aliases from a zsh configuration file in alphabetical order
```
3.

```
alias list-aliases='bash -c '""'shell_conf="${1:-$HOME/.bashrc}"; [ -f "$shell_conf" ] || { echo "Configuration file not found: $shell_conf"; exit 1; }; grep -E "^[[:space:]]*alias[[:space:]]" "$shell_conf" | sed -E "s/^[[:space:]]*alias[[:space:]]*/" | sort -f | while IFS= read -r line; do alias_name=${line%*=*}; alias_cmd=${line#*=*}; printf "\{\}\{033[1;34m%-20s\}\{033[0m -> \{\}\{033[1;32m%s\}\{033[0m\}\{033[0m\}\{033[0m\n" "$alias_name" "$alias_cmd"; done'""' -' - Create a permanent alias for listing all aliases in alphabetical order
```

Output

```
\033[1;34mdocker-rm-stopped \033[0m -> \033[1;32m'docker
rm $(docker ps -aq --filter status=exited)'\033[0m
\033[1;34mgs \033[0m -> \033[1;32m'git
status"\033[0m
```

```
\033[1;34mll          \033[0m -> \033[1;32m'ls -la
'\033[0m
\033[1;34mup          \033[0m -> \033[1;32m'uptime
'\033[0m
```

Notes

- The command works with bash, zsh, and other shells by specifying the appropriate configuration file
- Color codes: alias names are displayed in blue, commands in green
- Alias names are listed in alphabetical order
- The command text is shown exactly as stored after the equals sign
- Can be used directly or converted to a permanent alias
- Works on Linux and BSD systems

Warnings

- Only shows aliases defined in the specified configuration file
- Does not display aliases defined in sessions or other files
- May not work with non-standard alias definitions

See Also

- [replace-string-in-files](#)

Status

reviewed

Safety

safe

Shell

bash

Platforms

linux, gnu-linux, freebsd, openbsd, netbsd

Created At

2026-04-25

Updated At

2026-04-25